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Mt.Mansfield Modified Union School District

February 2016

Revisioning World Language Learning to Educate our Children in the 21st Century

Language Immersion White Paper

The Mt.Mansfield Modified Union School district consists of five elementary schools, two middle schools and one high school. We currently provide some world language instruction in every grade. To clarify definitions, terminology was changed from "foreign" to "world" language to present a more inclusive manner of referencing non-English languages. The purpose of this paper is to share research about the importance of teaching children languages other than English, and the viability and importance of a strong world language program in our school district, including but not limited to language immersion.

In the spring, summer and fall of 2015 a committee of parents, board members, teachers and school administrators met to research and make a recommendation concerning a World Language Immersion Program (LIP). Members of the committee read, interviewed and discussed options and helped produce this document. We spoke with other school leaders, combed online databases and journal articles and convened eight meetings. Our findings below summarize the work.

The white paper includes a number of sections. The first section reviews the broad context- why we are considering changing our language program to include, among other things, language immersion. The second section is a brief summary of the history, resources and data concerning language immersion in the United States (and Canada). The White Paper then lists benefits, drawbacks and specifics, then sets forth a timeline and steps forward.

Broad Context for Language Immersion

Our country faces a need for proficiency in non English languages, and it is reported as one of the greatest needs for business, diplomacy, education, national security and social services. Developing individuals with a high level of language proficiency in other languages is essential for our country (Malone, Rifken, Christian & Johnson, 2005). Our reading, cited in the

bibliography/reference list, showed time and time again the value of language learning for a global 21st century economy. Our worldwide economic and socio-political interdependency continues to grow. As we work to address world issues such as climate change, international trade or terrorism, and with the accessibility of all cultures through the internet, there is an increased need to understand multiple cultures and languages.

Equipping our young learners with dual language understanding, prepares them to communicate. This also trains young brains to have the capacity to learn second (and third and fourth) languages (Baker & Garcia, 1995; MacIntyre, Baker, Clément, & Conrod, 2001). Additionally, when our current kindergarten students are sophomores in college, by 2030, it is estimated that immigrants will make up over 20% of the US workforce (National Council of State Directors of Adult Education). One recent report cites US Census data that last year, 63.2 million US residents (about 20%) spoke a non-English language in their home (Bedard, 2015). Not only are we looking outside our borders to use language understanding, our neighbors down the street will speak multiple languages. To compete, it is essential that we prepare our children for this seismic demographic shift. One way to address the need for language instruction is language immersion programs. A year ago, NBC nightly news produced a report on the surge in language immersion programs, highlighting the importance in our changing world.

Language Immersion Programs: History, Resources, Data

Currently, most secondary schools provide an option for world language courses. An increasing number of elementary schools in our state and country provide introductory language programs as well. The Center for Applied Linguistics (CAL) provides a directory of language programs in US schools. CAL has a number of resources, one of which is information concerning language immersion. We sought to improve our student learning and explore language immersion as we currently use other language options. Later in this paper we explain the current world language programs in CESU and adjustments to our current programs over time.

CAL provides a list of three different types of immersion programs, full, partial and dual. For our district, the only viable options are full immersion and partial immersion. By means of a definition, in partial and full immersion, all the children entering the program have English as their first language. For full immersion, all of the schooling is in the non-English language. For partial immersion, half the day is in the non-English language, and the other half is in English. There is a third option employed in some schools called dual or two-way immersion. This is when a section of the population speaks English as a first language and a section speaks a non-English language such as Spanish as a first language. In two-way immersion half the class is new to, for example, speaking Spanish and the other half is new to speaking English. Because there are fewer than 20 English Language Learners in PK-12 in our district, this option was not considered.

Utah (58 schools in 15 districts), Minnesota (46 schools in 19 districts) and California (14 schools in 12 districts) have the greatest number of public school language immersion programs in the United States. Nationwide, in 1973 there were fewer than ten immersion programs. In 2011, the CAL showed school and district self-reported data on 528 programs in 22 languages in 33 states. The most common language being Spanish, followed by French and Mandarin. Connecticut, Maine, New Hampshire, Rhode Island and Vermont, as of 2011, had no public school immersion programs. The only New England state with immersion is Massachusetts with 15 public school programs.

The CAL website provides resources, research, language materials, technical assistance and professional development for school districts and other entities working with immersion, language learning or considering new programs. Their research has shown that for language immersion in public schools, recurrent costs are similar for language immersion programs as traditional academic programs. There may be initial start up expenditures, but once the program is established, continuing the program has no added yearly cost as compared to a non-immersion classroom (Malone, 2005; Tucker, 1999).

Benefits of Immersion

North American language immersion programs grew and developed in Canada where English speaking students were taught French (Canada has two official languages. In Quebec, French is widely spoken.) The research on immersion programs has taught us that it is important to incorporate the normal classroom content with the language. Classrooms must be discussion rich, the curriculum must be planned in a comprehensive and cohesive manner. Teaching the second language in isolation is not nearly as effective (Genesee, 1995). Currently in our school district we teach language as a "special," a child leaves his or her homeroom classroom, or the world language teacher comes into the class. The world language content is taught largely in isolation of the daily routines and regular classroom. Research on the immersion programs in Canada illustrated that children learned more when they are required to speak the language as a normal part of their school and social situation. It is more interesting for the children, their minds are developmentally ready to learn, and simply hanging up coats, putting away backpacks, eating snacks and speaking in a language other than English becomes a natural part of their growth and development in immersion programs. When authentic, the interactions are purposeful, not contrived. Children know and can understand this difference thereby fluidly acquiring the language. The language is not an abstract course-- which is confusing for our developmentally youngest learners. In immersion the language is both necessary and substantive. Children have social interactions, and they use language - as they grow there is an interconnectedness with cognition, social awareness and the words and language they use. With immersion, these components are used together which provide further understanding (Genesee, 1995; Spanos, Rhodes, Dale, & Crandall, 1988).

As adults it may be difficult to imagine how rapidly a young mind is changing and learning. We experience this when our own children repeat a phrase, action, expression or behavior that perhaps we did not want them to learn. They absorb all around them. This is the idea with language immersion. For example, evidence indicates that the way language is used in particular academic domains, such as mathematics -- we toss the dice, count cubes and add numbers -- is not the same in other academic domains, such as social studies where we talk about how to pass a bill, our constitution or the geography of the world (Genesee, 1995; Short, 1994; Spanos, Rhodes, Dale, & Crandall, 1988). Using multiple and varied integrated approaches to second language teaching using immersion, allows for the subtle differences in both content and the interactions around the content. Immersion is a specific type of integrated instruction. The primary focus of immersion is not language learning but academic instruction. According to Genessee (1995):

> Immersion programs have proved to be successful; the academic achievement of immersion students is comparable to that of students educated through their native language. This indicates that the students in immersion programs acquire the second language skills they need to master the academic skills and information appropriate for their grade level.

According to the Center for Applied Linguistics, foreign language immersion programs are the most effective and fastest-growing forms of foreign language instruction currently available in the U.S. (www.cal.org). D'Angiulli, Siegel and Serra, (2001) found that bilingual students (ages 9-10) scored higher on word-reading and spelling tasks than monolingual students did. Therese Sullivan Cavaccale (2007) reports that multiple studies have demonstrated that foreign language learning increases critical thinking skills, creativity, and cognitive flexibility. Furthermore, students who are learning a foreign language out-score their non-foreign language learning peers in both verbal and math sections of standardized tests. Interestingly, language learning seems to be more proficient in a cognitive problem-solving task than a linguistic activity per se, thereby contributing to cognitive flexibility. ("Cognitive Benefits of Learning Language", Duke Gifted Letter, Volume 1, Issue 8, Fall 2007).

Stewart (2005) discusses research which demonstrates that foreign language study in the early elementary grades has a positive impact on achievement in other disciplines, and correlates with higher scores on both reading and math achievement tests. In a dissertation study, Cade (1997) describes in detail the foreign language magnet program in the Kansas City, Missouri Public School District. The program outcomes appear to lend support to research findings which have indicated that foreign language learners have improved standardized test scores, are able to think divergently, and achieve in their native language. Once children reach the age of about nine, or the beginning of puberty, their ability to think and translate languages and social cues in a particular language changes. Children who acquire the language before this age have little

difficulty with pronunciation or language and code switching, the act is a normal part of their thinking (McLaughlin, 1995).

Research supports language immersion. In fact, the only argument against such a program centers around logistics, cost and other details concerning the quality and viability of initiating such a program in a region of the country with few peer school districts with which to grow. It is difficult to be out in front on a particular initiative. However, we know language immersion improves the thinking and cognitive ability of our children. We know it will be useful for our young learners when they reach adulthood. The question then becomes if we were to adopt a language immersion program in our school district, what would it look like? What would it cost? How do we pilot and transition to such a program? What are the logistics involved? Who enrolls in the program, how are they chosen and how do we support world language learning for children who are not able to access the immersion?

Drawbacks of Implementing Immersion

Before we consider scenarios and details, it is important to list some of our team's exploration around the drawbacks of a language immersion program. First we must consider the impact on the school community. The children enrolled could face a 'have' versus 'have-nots' situation. In our research we found that once the "honeymoon" of a new program was over, other language immersion programs or teachers experienced some form of isolation from the rest of the community. As they go through the grades because the children in language immersion are learning another language, this could create discrepancies, participation and program differences among children and families. This must be considered as it could create tension. This must be addressed with communication, training and support. A language immersion program adds a whole new dimension of cultural sensitivity and awareness for and among both families, the school faculty and staff and the broader community.

Another potential drawback when considering immersion concerns other disciplines and the importance of well rounded children and a decision to pursue language immersion versus other programs such as aesthetic, cultural and technological programs. For example, we should be asking why not more opportunities for fine arts? Our children are aesthetic beings by nature. Why not music such as violin instruction for all children beginning in kindergarten? Why not experiential learning? Why not technology or an engineering magnet type program? There is no doubt that each of these disciplines should be integrated into the learning the way an immersion class would. In fact some countries, such as Finland, have the arts embedded, the classroom teacher also teaches music and art. Waldorf education embraces this philosophy. The idea of immersion is not in the absence of these other programs or philosophies, it can be in combination. This white paper only addresses the possibility for language immersion. This puts a spotlight specifically on the spoken and written languages.

In addition, there are budgetary concerns with the start up of the program. The program, in the absence of natural teacher attrition, could change the balance of qualifications for

elementary teachers and could include reductions in the least senior teachers of the elementary teaching staff. The logistics and visa considerations of hiring individuals could be a hurdle, programs in Minnesota, Virginia and Utah all expressed time and energy needed to recruit and then bring native Spanish speaking teachers. Simply put, there are not a lot of licensed elementary teachers who are native Spanish speakers in our applicant pools. The individuals exist, they must be actively sought and recruited.

All of the drawbacks can be overcome. Our school district has the capacity and nimble governance structure to explore such a program. The first step would be further discussion, and a decision to move forward with a pilot immersion program. This next section addresses some of the logistics in establishing a program.

Logistical Considerations for Mt. Mansfield School District

Our team interviewed school administrators in Virginia, Minnesota and Utah. We spoke to parents whose children are in programs, and explored various details. From the information garnered we created a spreadsheet with our interview findings. What follows in this white paper are all of our logistical considerations created by considering the information we gathered. While not always mentioned in the following passages specifically, the recommendations are based on other schools that have implemented programs and their success and suggestions.

In the Mt. Mansfield School District, because five elementary school districts have merged into one, a language immersion program would be able to draw children from all five of our elementary schools. Parents, as part of the kindergarten registration process, would opt for language immersion. The program, goals, description and logistics would be explained. If there were more parents than spaces available we would initiate a lottery. The program would be open to all entering kindergarten children, regardless of their town of residence. We would need to allow for anomalies in bus transportation as part of the program. This would be addressed as we determined enrollments.

Our team considered both full and partial immersion, and determined that the best route to take would be partial immersion beginning in kindergarten. Children would register for and attend school in the same way they would for a regular kindergarten. The difference is that they would have two kindergarten teachers, each for half of the day. One teacher would teach math, social studies and science in Spanish, the other teacher would teach reading, writing and all the specials (music, guidance, PE, art, library) would be in English. The decision to divide into these subject areas was based on the research into schools in Minnesota and Virginia. There are Spanish texts available in math, science and social studies. The children will have Spanish language books in both classrooms. Together there would be two teachers and two homeroom classes, and the children would move fluidly between the Spanish Immersion teacher and the English speaking teacher. Both teachers would be licensed in elementary education. The Spanish immersion teacher would be a native Spanish speaker. Both classes would follow the same curriculum as the rest of the district.

Our team considered multiple languages and after researching and weighing options, they determined that Spanish would be the best fit. First, there are more resources in print that are available and align with our curriculum. Second, Spanish is the second most commonly spoken language in the United States. Research has shown that learning an Indo European language with the same writing as English can help children progress faster. Languages such as Arabic or Japanese which have other language families and writing systems have been shown to take up to two or three times longer to learn. (Walqui, Ed, 2000). Being an Indo-European language, there are cognates and a similar alphabet which both allow for more immediate retention. We discussed French, Mandarin and Arabic among other possibilities. The team decided that Spanish is the most viable to begin a pilot. The primary reason is the availability of resources, both written language books (our Investigations math texts are available in Spanish) and the resources of support from other school districts. While Mandarin and French are both appropriate for language immersion, the experience and availability of resources, thus ensuring a more effective and successful program, is the predominant reason to begin with Spanish.

The team collected the following benefits of language immersion for the community. We considered primary, secondary and tertiary benefits. The primary benefits are measurable and based on peer- reviewed research concerning second language acquisition. The secondary and tertiary benefits are ones mentioned to occur in other programs through our interviews. Although these benefits are anecdotal, at least two other communities with language immersion mentioned them as outcomes of language immersion.

Primary benefits

- Increased language and literacy skills
- Strengthened problem solving and brain capacity skills given second language is learned at an early age
- Knowledge of a second language and functionality in our global world- social, economic, political nimbleness
- Improved understanding and cultural awareness

Secondary benefits for the greater community

- Knowledge and understanding of other cultures and languages as part of the community

Tertiary benefits - mentioned by other individuals with language immersion programs.

- Attraction of newcomers to the school district based on the availability of the program
- Increased migration into the district and/or greater student population and/ or economic growth
- Potential increase in property values based on immersion offerings in the schools

In addition to Spanish immersion, all children not in the immersion program in elementary school will continue to have exposure to Spanish once a week. The kindergarten immersion class, when they become 1st graders will continue with a new, 1st grade immersion teacher. Each year, as the children progress through 5th grade, they will have half of their classes taught in Spanish and half in English. Given personnel and hiring, this would mean hiring a native Spanish speaking teacher in K, then in grades one, two, three, four and five over the course of 6 years. The hiring would not necessarily displace elementary teachers and could be continued through natural attrition. Over the course of six years there will be six different elementary teachers who are able to teach the language immersion portion of the the student day.

When the immersion students enter middle school, it is important to expand the language offerings for other students and provide further study for the language immersion students. Schools in Minnesota have adopted this program to allow for equity among children. Five years from now, the non-immersion 5th-grade children would take a survey of languages course, similar to what we currently teach in 6th and 7th grade. Then in 6th grade students could choose a specific language, and then complete all of French I or Spanish I in 6th and 7th grade. In the 8th grade students would have the option to continue their study of French I or Spanish I or enroll in a transitional French II or Spanish II, readying them for high school. The immersion students would have Spanish literature and writing classes in grade 6, 7 and 8, and be able to take the advanced placement Spanish examination in 8th grade. When immersion students enter high school they could take a third language, and/or use dual enrollment to take further advanced Spanish courses at the University of Vermont, St. Michaels or online. The research shows us that through partial immersion, by the time students reach 8th grade they are fluent in the immersion language.

Chart I: Language Immersion New Personnel/texts Timeline

First 6 years (2017-2023)	**Year 5-8** (2022-2026)	**Year 9 and beyond** (2026 and beyond)
Hire a native speaking Spanish teacher each year, beginning in K	Expand middle school language offerings, increase FTE as needed. Grade 5- Survey of languages, Grade 6,7 Spanish/French I, Grade 8 Spanish/French I or II.	Increase or expand language offerings in high school as needed
Each new year purchase texts, reading materials and supplies in Spanish. Every year	Purchase materials to maintain the current language programs with an increase in	Depending on need, increase the number of sections of language offerings, provide

thereafter purchase materials to maintain the program -- similar to purchasing regular classroom materials	the number of new children enrolling in the language courses. -- similar to purchasing regular classroom materials	access to further advanced classes at UVM, St. Mikes or online.

Language Immersion Costs Outline

Program

1) Half Day
    a) One school, two sections 18-20 children each
        i) School location will be determined based on geographic proximity, availability of space and administrative oversight
    b) Two teachers, one English, one Spanish, children have half and half
        i) Spanish teacher a native Spanish speaker
            (1) Vermont Bilingual Education endorsement that we currently have would meet the licensing need.
            (2) The applicant would be applying for a Bilingual Education "Spanish" endorsement.
        ii) English teacher has commitment to the language immersion and has some college level Spanish experience.
    c) Spanish- Social studies, science, math; English- reading, writing, all specials
    d) Open to all students in Bolton, Jericho, Richmond and Underhill through a lottery
    e) Begin in K as a pilot. Evaluate in November of 1st year. If successful, add on grade each year for four years, in five years increase offerings in middle school in all grades

2) Startup cost: Total $19,000 to $33,000
    a) Recruitment and visa $8,000
    b) Materials and supplies $5,000
    c) Training $6,000
    d) Coordination -.20 FTE or included in current position $0 - $14,000
    e) All other costs associated with the school as is- yearly needs of supplies and materials

3) Program Steps
    a) Approval of board/ superintendent- pilot
    b) Clarity of outcomes and results
    c) Recruitment of teachers
    d) Communication to community, family, schools
    e) Design and set up training
        i) Coordinator

ii) Professional Development
iii) Training for immersion teachers
iv) Time for professional development for teachers

CESU Current Language Instruction

Currently all Mt Mansfield School District schools provide World Language instruction in all grades. In grade K-5, students receive Spanish instruction for each grade for approximately 45 minutes a week. In our middle schools at the 5th grade children continue with approximately 45 minutes a week in Spanish. In 6th grade, students are exposed to a variety of languages from around the world, also for approximately 45 minutes a week. In 7th grade world language classes meet for about 45 minutes three times a week and the curriculum focuses on multiple languages as well, including specifically the three -- Latin, Spanish and French - offered in the upper grades. In 8th grade students chose between French I and Spanish I and take a daily, year long class. From here forward students enroll in various language specific leveled by each year language courses. Chart 2: CESU Language Instruction summarizes the current offerings in the CESU/Mt. Mansfield Modified Union School District.

Chart 2: 2015-16 CESU Language Instruction

Grade	K-5	6	7	8	9-12
Course description	Intro to Spanish and Spanish culture, basic language and phrases	French, Spanish, Chinese, Russian, introduction to culture, letters, alphabet, greetings	French, Spanish, Latin, trimester study of each.	Individual courses: French I and Spanish I	Individual courses: French I-IV, AP Spanish I-IV, AP, Latin 1-IV
Approx hours	22 -26 hrs/yr	22-26 hrs/yr	88- 96 hrs/yr	135 hrs/yr	128 hrs/yr

Our neighboring schools (Essex, Williston, South Burlington and Stowe) offer 7th and 8th grade Spanish I and French I as a two year program. These schools have more contact time in the middle school for language studies.

At the high school level, there are three languages offered, Spanish, French and Latin, In addition Mt. Mansfield students can enroll in classes through the Vermont Virtual Learning Cooperative (VTVLC) which offers German. In the last four years, MMU students have enrolled in sign language (7 students) and Elementary Arabic (1 student). One of MMU's Spanish teacher teaches Spanish 1 online. This course is available to any student in Vermont. She has been doing this for six years and it allows MMU students to enroll in scores of VTVLC

courses. The Vermont online course is always in high demand and enrolls the maximum of 25 students per section. The vast majority of these students are from other Vermont high schools that are not able to take Spanish at their local school. MMU students have enrolled in German, Latin and Spanish through VTVLC. Three years ago our high school language program initiated Middlebury Interactive, which is an online, spoken supplement to our classroom instruction. While there have been some technological bumps, student spoken fluency has increased.

Some current concerns about our world language instruction relate to our middle school program and the 6th and 7th grade exploratory classes. At this age developmentally, students are able to focus and learn a second language. It is appropriate to increase the amount of language instruction for our students in 6th and 7th grade. The plan forward for language immersion allows for a change at the younger grades. As we transition in the years to come, we should simultaneously increase the offerings in the middle school for all children. We recommend that we return to high school French and Spanish 1 courses over two years in 7th and 8th grade as a transition in the middle school between now and when immersion is fully implemented. A two year program gives teachers more time to use age appropriate activities and assessments and modify curricula accordingly.

CESU World Language teachers have a common Mission Statement. This statement was written a number of years ago, and given the shifts in our global culture, our committee supports this mission and realizes that we should take language learning to the next step.

> *Our mission is to prepare students to participate in local and global communities with an international mindset. We believe that in a world shaped by global politics and economics, global literacy cannot exist without modern language and culture instruction. The study of world languages and cultures enriches and enhances lifelong learning experiences and achievements, while promoting greater intellectual development.*

Ten years ago Chittenden East Supervisory Union began providing Spanish instruction in the elementary grades. Looking at data, two years ago our high school Spanish 4 course enrolled 17 students, and one section has been the norm for a number of previous years. This year, with the initial elementary Spanish language learners now in high school, there are two sections of Spanish 4 with 20 students each - for a total of 40 students. Additionally this year there are 130 students in Latin I. This number has held steady, despite the population drop at the high school of over 100 students. There are a higher percentage of students taking world language courses at the high school. While these are pure numbers and they do not necessarily show causality, they show a thriving world language program in our high school.

There is no doubt that our lives are more globally connected. We share learning with children all over the world, we share ideas with teachers throughout the country and the world. The availability of technology to reach more people, faster and more effectively has transformed

how we think about learning and the role of education. In addition, our problems have become global.

Language Immersion Plan

Vision: Our vision is to improve literacy, language learning and cultural competence, by preparing our youth for the 21st century. We believe that multilingualism is essential for our children to thrive in our region, state, nation and world. We believe that learning and speaking a second language expands the brain and increases capacity for our young learners.

Goals: Improve and increase non-English language education in the elementary and middle schools.

Action Steps: Begin a language immersion program in the elementary schools that continues through the middle school years. Provide a more comprehensive language program in the middle schools for children not enrolled in the immersion program. As needed, increase language programming at the high school.

Political Implications- statewide

- Consider advocating at the state level for "charter" "open enrollment" or "elementary school choice" to increase participation for this essential and innovative program.
- Increasing the world language programming at the middle school addresses children are not initially enrolled in the immersion program- beginning in 5th grade
- Work with the Vermont Agency of Education and teacher licensing and reciprocity with obtaining elementary licenses in Vermont- from international schools.

Next Steps to implement language immersion

February 2016

- Presentation and approval for year 1 of a pilot immersion program to begin in the fall.

March 2016

- Delegate an individual to coordinate the planning for a year 1 - pilot year.
- Determine how the pilot year will be evaluated, and plan a timeline for continuing into a second year. Create a timeline for parent notification and a process for enrollment.

Spring 2016

- Implement a timeline to plan for recruiting and hiring an immersion teacher.

Fall 2016:

- Community input and interest: Provide information sessions, flyers, public meetings. Share information in the school and the community to gain both interest, adjustments and support (or determine if there is not any support) for the program.
- Research, advertise and recruit language immersion teacher
- Add language immersion costs to the budget

December 2016-Feb 2017

- Plan training and transition into the program

February - May 2017

- Finalize enrollment
- Finalize teacher, location, transportation and training

Summer 2017

- Implement Training

Action Steps: Each year, beginning with the fall of 2017, have two elementary K classes be 50-50 immersion in Spanish. This class will stay immersion through 5th grade. The following year, a second K class will begin with two sections of 50-50 K immersion, and this will continue forward. At the same time we will increase and improve all language offerings (for children not in immersion) beginning in 5th grade, starting in the fall of 2021. The immersion program will continue until 5th grade. In 6th, 7th and 8th grade the students who entered the immersion program will then take "advanced language" classes in Spanish, and prepare in a full English curriculum.

Immersion K class enrollment: open to all K children in Mt. Mansfield Modified Union School District. There will be applications and a lottery. Location will be based on the final lottery. Currently there are between nine and eleven Kindergarten classes each year, two would be immersion.

Fall 2017 Kindergarten - two classes full year, half immersion in Spanish Language

- Advertise and recruit teacher
    - Branding and advertising the program- Seek international schools in Europe or South America who would be interested in partnering
    - Create application process and requirements outline- using schoolspring
    - Interview and select applicants

    - Hire elementary certified native speaking teacher, conduct background work for reciprocity for licensing and visas
- District wide information and school community information sessions
- Parent and community information nights
    - Student enrollment applications submitted by February 1, 2017
    - Student enrollment and school selected by March 2017
    - Canvass for interest- make it clear that this is a pilot year and there are many details to be worked out
    - Determine school site
    - Determine transportation
    - Parent information-
        - In the support and promotion of the program establish minimum enrollment requirements, minimum year participation and address the "honeymoon syndrome." Other schools shared that given immersion, parents and families feel privileged to have their child part of an innovative program. As time goes on, it is important to keep an open lens to learning. Some children flourish, some struggle. It is important for parents to think about the personality of their children, goals, and expansive thinking. When children struggle, it is important to provide the support.
- Each class will have a teacher for half the day in Spanish and half the day in English. For example, 18-20 children would have the Spanish teacher for the morning, and the English speaking teacher in the afternoon. Another class would have the Spanish in the afternoon and the English in the morning. Half way they would switch. This way each child would have a half day full instruction in Spanish.
    - order books, literacy, math
- Teacher Training
    - Provide training and professional development for immersion/English language teacher, entire school faculty
    - Pathwise and mentoring for the new Spanish language teacher
    - Partner with local university with strong language program to provide support and mentoring
- Assessment: Quantitative and qualitative research.
    1) Yearly visits from outside native language speakers on conversationalism and content knowledge.
    2) Use UVM and St. Mikes/ Middlebury to evaluate the language instruction and learning
    3) Prepare a long term study of the children and their outcomes

Language Immersion Ad Hoc Committee Participants: *Some members attended one or several meetings, some attended all meetings, some were only able to provide insight on the written minutes and documents.*

Britni Bigelow, parent, elementary Spanish teacher
Jen Botzojorns, CESU Curriculum Director
Tracy Dolan, parent
Victoria Graf, Jericho Elementary School Principal
Sherry Harris, parent, CESU elementary Spanish teacher
Joshua Knox, MMU Lead World Language Teacher
Susan Lillich, parent, MMMUSD board member
Chip Noonan, MMMUSD Board member, parent
Daisy Reina, CESU elementary Spanish teacher
Laura Zambarano, parent, CESU middle school Spanish teacher

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